

Lesson 4

Scheduling

Lesson objectives

- Describe the basic of schedules
- Explain different phases in creating schedules
- Explain the procedure to enable, disable and delete schedules
- Explain the steps to set up schedules for reports and stand-alone services.

Scheduling Basics

In Sterling B2B Integrator, a schedule is a resource in the database that stores time and date information separately from the activity being scheduled.

Schedules identify when to run an activity and when to skip the normal interval by excluding a certain time, time range, or date.

Different Phases

The different phases in creating schedules are:

Phase 1: Scheduling Prerequisites and Setup in a Test Environment

Phase 2: Testing Schedules in a Test Environment

Phase 3: Exporting Schedules to the Production Environment

Scheduling Prerequisites

- Appropriate license file for the services and activities you want to schedule.
- Appropriate security permissions applied to your user account.

Scheduling Permissions

Parameter	Description
UI BP Manager	Enables you to download the Graphical Process Modeler, and create and manage business processes.
UI Reports	Enables you to create, manage, and schedule reports.
UI Services	Enables you to install, configure, manage, and schedule services.
UI Scheduler	Enables you to schedule business processes, search for schedules and edit business process and service schedules.
UI Import/Export	Enables you to export the schedules and associated business processes, services, or reports to another system of the application, and import the schedules and resources into the application.
UI Logs	Enables you to view the schedule.log and reports.log files for troubleshooting schedules.

Scheduling Considerations

- Are you scheduling a business process, report, or service?
- If scheduling a business process, does data need to be passed to the business process?
- Who or what business process or service needs the output from the scheduled business process, service, or report?
- Is the business process or service that uses the output also scheduled?
- Are you running the business process, service, or report manually as well as on a schedule?

Deadlines That Impact Scheduled Times:

Are there internal and external deadlines that impact when the schedule should be set? Deadlines can determine the dates and times when an activity should be scheduled to run. The examples are:

- Reporting time frames for your company
- Priority or strategy changes of your company
- Trading partner agreements

Scheduling Considerations

(contd..)

Dates That Impact Excluded Times:

Are there dates or times when the schedule does not need to run? Holidays and other events can determine the dates and times that a schedule should exclude or that a low priority schedule should include. The examples are:

- Holidays and company calendars
- Periods of higher processing times during the quarter
- Scheduled maintenance of the application or other systems that integrate with the application, either at your company or your trading partners.

Scheduling Considerations

(contd..)

Peak and Non-peak Processing Time:

Peak and non-peak processing times can help you determine when to run high priority and low priority activities in the application to increase performance and maximize the use of system resources. The examples are:

- You receive the largest amount of processing requests for the application every day between 8:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m.
- You receive the least amount of processing requests for the application every day between 2:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m.

Scheduling Considerations

(contd..)

The Processing Time and Frequency of the Scheduled Activity:

The processing time and frequency of the activity being scheduled impacts scheduling intervals. The examples are:

- Total processing time required for the business process, service, or report
- Frequency that the data or processing is required

Schedules for Report

Setting up schedules for reports will automatically generate reports on hourly, daily, weekly, or monthly intervals.

Consider these guidelines:

- The report configuration must exist before you set up the schedule.
- You can have only one schedule per report configuration.
- After a scheduled report is generated, it can be stored on the file system or e-mailed (in .zip format) to a recipient. You set up these choices as part of the report schedule.

Schedules for Report

(contd..)

- Creating a schedule for a report automatically creates a business process using the default report name `reportname_scheduleBP`. The business process for a schedule is listed with other business processes when you select Deployment > Schedules > List > Business Processes.
- You can also schedule a report through the Report Service, if the report configuration is predefined and you supply the report configuration name and the format of the report.

Schedules for Stand-alone Services

User can set up schedules only for those services and adapters that run as a stand-alone service. Creating a schedule for a service is part of creating the service configuration.

Consider these guidelines:

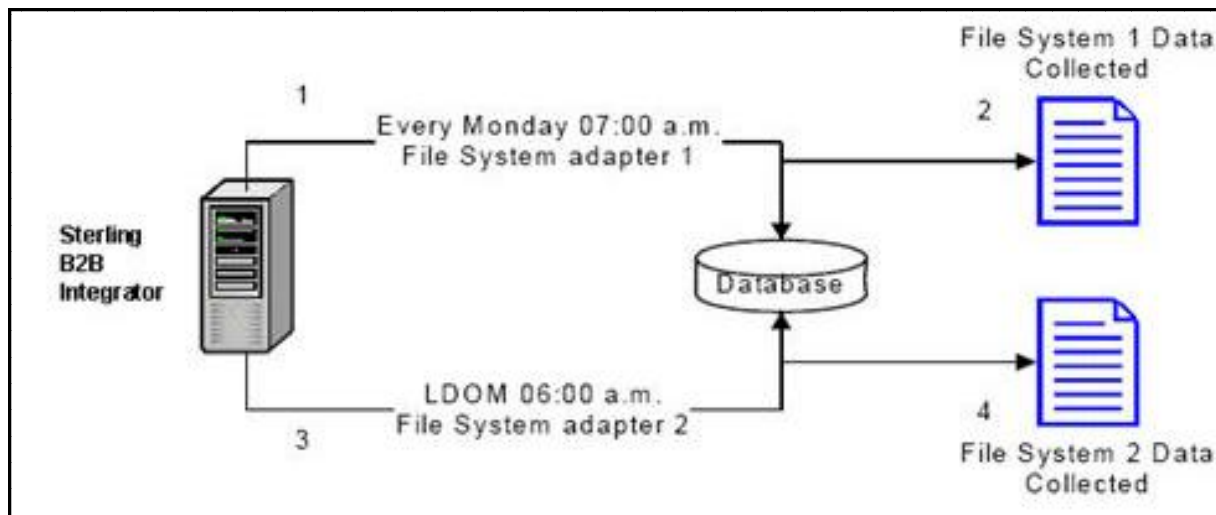
- You cannot create a schedule and apply it to many services at the same time.
- The schedule settings are stored in the database and are internal to the application only. Schedules for applications that are external to the application do not impact the service and adapters schedules that are created within the application.

Schedules for Stand-alone Services

(contd..)

- Some stand-alone services and adapters are supplied with default schedules when the application is installed.
- The Run as User option is available only to super users. It is not available to subgroups of the Admin group or other groups.

Example - Stand-alone Service Schedule



This example consists of two scheduling activities:

- Scheduling a File System adapter one day each week at a specific time. (Weekly schedule)
- Scheduling a Gentran:Server Windows adapter one day a month at a specific time. (Monthly schedule)

Default Schedules

Some services and adapters are supplied with default schedules when the application is installed. You can edit the default schedules to meet your needs.

For example:

Service or Adapter Supplied	Default Schedule Settings
AFTPurgeArchiveMailboxes Ensures that messages stored in AFT's archive mailboxes are made eligible for purging soon after their corresponding AFT Routes are purged	Enabled: Yes Schedule Type: Business Process Timer or Clock: Clock System: node1 Execution Day: Every Day Scheduled Time(s): 04:00 a.m. Excluded Time(s): None Excluded Dates: None At startup: No Run As User: Admin

Benefits

The benefits of scheduling include:

- Flexibility, including setting time intervals and excluding dates and times
- Increased efficiency by automating manual processes
- Improved response times with trading partners and other members of value chain
- Automating routine, recurring tasks and controlling when and how often the tasks are completed
- Reducing costs associated with performing activities manually
- Increasing overall productivity by using resources effectively



Exercise

1. Create a Report

Completed lesson objectives

- Describe the basic of schedules
- Explain different phases in creating schedules
- Explain the procedure to enable, disable and delete schedules
- Explain the steps to set up schedules for reports and stand-alone services.

Questions

